

women facing extraordinary challenges. This constructs a more compelling social narrative reflecting the appetite of the time for success stories that are accessible. This is evident at the beginning of the advert when the dream sequence is shattered, and real life begins.

question their assumptions and be more open to the representations in advertisements like *Super: Human.*, which offers a refreshing and more realistic perception of what it means to be disabled and one that challenges common preconceptions and mainstream values.

Consider theoretical perspectives: Reception theory – Stuart Hall

- The upbeat soundtrack, use of personalisation and positive representations of the event and the athletes as both ‘Super’ and ‘Human’, encourages an audience to accept the ideologies and **intended meaning** of Channel 4, the encoder, in creating the advertisement. The use of real people creates a preferred reading that the audience should invest in their narratives and subsequently watch the Paralympic Games.
- Some audiences may adopt a **negotiated position**, acknowledging the legitimacy of the encoder’s position, but may feel more distanced from the sporting theme of the event. However, this audience may be more open to the positive approach of the advertisement and examine their misconceptions about disabled people and their lives more generally.
- **Oppositional responses** may come from those who are not supporters of Channel 4 and its ethos of giving voice to those who are under-represented. They may be older, not regular viewers of Channel 4 or not interested in sport of any kind.

Cultivation theory – George Gerbner

- This theory suggests that audiences may have become used to the conventions of this sub-genre of advertising which raises awareness of a particular social group. Due to the repetition of certain codes and conventions, for example, the focus on the specific disability accompanied by a voice-over with serious mode of address, they may accept this view of the world and perhaps be somewhat ‘immune’ to their purpose.
- Alternatively, this advertisement can also be said to challenge Gerbner’s assertions. As a result of viewing advertisements whose aim is to raise awareness and give a voice to previously under-represented groups, audiences may